



Tandy Corporation

News Release

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TANDY CORPORATION ANNOUNCES NEW COMPUTER HARDWARE AND SOFTWARE PRODUCTS

FORT WORTH, TEXAS -- Tandy Corporation, the leading supplier of PC-compatible personal computers, today introduced its new technology products for 1989, to a gathering of financial analysts and the media. Among the offerings are three new personal computers designed and manufactured in the U.S. by Tandy, along with new software offerings which greatly enhances the ease of use of computers. New features were demonstrated, which have never before been offered in a PC. The newly-introduced Tandy computers are locally sold, serviced and supported through the company's Radio Shack[®] outlets, America's leading distribution system for high technology electronics products.

The new Tandy[®] 4000 LX computer is a fast and powerful desktop computer based on the 20 megahertz (Mhz) 80386 microprocessor. The 4000 LX is Tandy's highest-performance computer using industry standard AT[®] bus architecture. Priced from \$3,999, the 4000 LX makes an ideal host for a XENIX[®] 386-based multi-user system. It also supports both the MS-DOS[®] 3.3 and MS[®] OS/2 operating systems, and is well suited as a file server in a network environment.

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TANDY COMPUTERS ANNOUNCED

Page Two

Two megabytes of included memory, three front and one internal storage device slots and flexible expansion options make the new Tandy 4000 LX unique in upper-end, name-brand AT-bus personal computers. An optional Small Computer Systems Interface (SCSI) controller - a Tandy first in the PC market - provides the most flexible, highest-performance data storage options available.

The 16Mhz 80386-based Tandy^R 4000 computer has been updated to include provisions for a plug-in 80387 math co-processor chip. In addition to three front-accessible drive slots, it is now possible to add an internal 3.5-inch hard disk. Suggested retail price remains at \$2,599.

New for 1989 is the Tandy^R 3000 NL computer, featuring industry-standard AT architecture, and a 10Mhz 80286 processor. This high-performance computer carries an economical starting price of only \$1,699, making it an excellent choice for use with the MS-DOS or MS OS/2 operating systems.

The 3000 NL's seven expansion slots are software configurable to operate at 8 or 10Mhz, for compatibility with hundreds of widely-available optional expansion boards. One additional high-performance dedicated memory expansion slot, allows access to 8 megabytes (Mb) of high-speed memory. The NL will support up to 16Mb. According to industry accepted Norton Utilities benchmarks, the new 3000 NL closely approaches the speed of IBM^R's new PS/2^R Model 50 Z.

Four front drive slots accept a wide variety of 3.5-inch and 5.25-inch storage devices. One 3.5-inch, 1.44Mb floppy drive is standard. The 3000 NL's parallel port is bi-directional, supporting input from devices such as scanners as well as printer output. The 3000 NL represents an

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exceptional value in a locally supported and serviced, American-made personal computer.

America's best-selling Tandy^R 1000 computer family has two new members, representing attractive new options for business, school and home users. The new Tandy^R 1000 TL computer is a low-cost XT-compatible which uses the Intel 80286 microprocessor to achieve speed three times that of IBM's PS/2 Models 25 and 30, and more than six times that of the original PC/XT. The new 8086-based Tandy^R 1000 SL computer is exceptionally affordable, and offers processing speed comparable to the Models 25 and 30, yet at a very affordable price.

In keeping with Tandy's dedication to improved ease-of-use, both the TL and SL now include another Tandy innovation... the MS-DOS version 3.3 operating system in permanent Read Only Memory (ROM) for instant-on operation. As soon as the computer is switched on, the user is greeted almost instantly by Tandy's friendly DeskMate^R graphical user interface, also stored in ROM. There are no cryptic "computerese" prompts. All functions are performed using simple, friendly pull-down menus.

Even system configuration information is stored permanently within the system, yet it may be easily changed by the user, should expansion or reconfiguration of the system be desired. Finally, there is an 80,000-word spell checker in ROM.

Both the TL and SL include a unique and innovative new feature... the ability to input, digitally record, edit, store and play back exceptionally high-quality voice and sound! This feature is one of the most exciting tools yet offered to creative software developers. Recordings rival high-fidelity audio tape recordings, yet can be edited by "cut and paste" methods, reversed, and

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TANDY COMPUTERS ANNOUNCED

Page Four

even combined in "sound-on-sound" fashion. Voice and sound input to the computer is via a microphone/audio input jack, and output is through a built-in speaker or headphone jack with volume control.

Serial and parallel ports as well as joystick ports are standard on both models, along with five 10-inch PC-compatible expansion slots. Both feature four on-board video standards, including two new high-resolution graphics modes.

Both the Tandy 1000 TL and the Tandy 1000 SL are supplied with 101-key keyboards, key-for-key compatible with IBM's Enhanced Keyboard, making them viable and exceptionally cost-effective choices for routine office work, work-at-home, classroom or homework needs.

The 1000 TL comes with 640 kilobytes (Kb) of RAM, and a real time clock. A 3.5-inch, 720Kb drive is standard. Two additional front drive slots accept another 3.5-inch and one 5.25-inch optional drive. The suggested retail price is \$1,299.

The Tandy 1000 SL computer is supplied with 384Kb of RAM, expandable to 640Kb, and one 5.25-inch 360Kb drive. One additional front slot accommodates either a 5.25-inch or 3.5-inch optional drive. Suggested retail price is only \$899.

The Tandy 1000 TL and SL computers have the DeskMate interface in ROM, and with an improved set of DeskMate applications (version 3.0) on disk. This easy to learn and use graphical interface is the only major product of its type which will run on affordable computers based on the 8088 and 8086-based computers with as little as 384Kb RAM. It provides new users with a variety of ready-to-use applications to make their computer immediately useful.

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The DeskMate interface, also licensed to a number of major software vendors for use on their own programs, includes a pull-down menu system, pop-up dialogue boxes, and more. DeskMate's unique benefit is the common user interface it provides for diverse applications. Each new application looks and feels familiar, and learning time is cut to a minimum.

DeskMate's "Desktop" appears when the computer is turned on. It displays boxes on the screen for each currently available application. Related data files are listed in each box.

DeskMate's own applications include TEXT, a simple text processor which now includes a spelling corrector, and a "mailmerge" ability to send automatic form letters to a selected list of names. Many other new and enhanced features have been added to TEXT in this release as well.

MUSIC and SOUND programs for the new SL and TL take advantage of their unique voice and sound capabilities. MUSIC even generates "sheet music" to the system printer.

ADDRESS is a new and simple but powerful address "card file" system which allows subdivision of the basic file into a number of discrete lists such as business contacts, church group, friends, PTA, Christmas card list, etc. The system offers innovative options which make it adaptable to a wide range of uses. ADDRESS is automatically linked with DeskMate's PHONE LIST, so that entries to one appear on both. Phone numbers may be dialed automatically if a modem is available.

CALENDAR is an appointment calendar which now allows for "Annual Occasions" like birthdays and anniversaries. "Reminder" entries appear each day until specifically removed. A "Things to do" box can be placed on the desktop, to display all reminders plus the current day's schedule.

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DRAW lets you express your artistic ability in more ways and more colors than in previous versions. It is a program that will provide hours of entertainment and will even let you produce graphics which can be cut and pasted into TEXT files.

DeskMate's standard worksheet and several other programs remain unchanged.

Also new this year is PC-LinkSM, an on-line information service provided by Quantum Computer Services. A local phone call can connect users to a wealth of data including stock quotes, movie reviews, news and sports headlines, and even an on-line encyclopedia. PC-Link's basic service is not billed at a per-hour price as are most services. The basic charge for use between the hours of 6 p.m. and 6 a.m. daily, plus all day weekends and holidays, is \$9.95 per month, regardless of on-line time!

PC-Link Plus is an extra-cost service which includes software vendor forums, on-line tutors to help with homework, electronic mail, special "auditorium" events with celebrities and industry experts and more. The PC-Link Plus surcharge is only ten cents per minute.

PC-Link also differs from other services in that it operates under the DeskMate interface. The same pull-down menus and dialogue boxes allow easy movement through the system. PC-Link treats connected PCs like intelligent workstations rather than "dumb terminals", so operation is faster, and gives the appearance of an off-line, disk-based application. Both DeskMate and PC-Link will also be sold as separate packages for use with any PC or PC-compatible computer.

A DeskMate workgroup option, the DeskMate Workgroup Companion is also available for simple interconnection of several computers. Connected users can transfer files electronically,

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TANDY COMPUTERS ANNOUNCED

Page Seven

exchange electronic mail, share a common phone list, or schedule meetings through a shared calendar function... all using the friendly DeskMate interface.

Tandy also introduced SchoolMate, a powerful yet easy to use classroom networking system based on the DeskMate interface, MS-DOS, and TandyLink^R network or the industry-standard 3Com^R network. SchoolMate is an integrated collection of applications designed to help students, teachers and administrators in organizing, creating and sharing information, software, time and resources. Thanks to the easy-to-use DeskMate interface, little training or prior knowledge is required to use the network. Applications like Roster, Grade Book, Lesson Scheduler and Exam Maker work together in a highly-integrated, well-balanced system. More than 80 existing education applications run on SchoolMate, and software vendors are working on additional products. The suggested retail price of SchoolMate, including 3Com's 3+ShareTM, is \$999.95.

Starting prices for the new Tandy computers are based on a single floppy disk drive, allowing customers to build the minimum configuration which best suits their individual needs. A full range of storage options are available. Prices are good at Radio Shack Computer Centers^R, Plus Computer Centers, and participating stores and dealers nationwide.

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